

Vibe Auth — Setup

Enable, sign in, and configure Vibe Auth on your Vibe Appliance.

Vibe Appliance setup guide · built 2026-09-17 · generated from the app's manifest · KisaesDevLab/Vibe-Appliance

1. What this app is

Single sign-on for firm staff across Vibe products (bundled authentik, MFA enforced, Entra ID / Google federation).

App id (slug)	vibe-auth
Uses	the appliance's shared postgres — nothing separate to install
Data lives in	database <code>vibe_auth</code> inside the appliance's Postgres — covered by your Duplicati backups and by the automatic pre-update dump

2. Before you enable it

- The appliance itself must be installed and healthy — see the **Vibe Appliance setup guide** first if you haven't done that yet.
- Each running app uses memory. Two or three apps fit a 2 GB server; for all of them plan on 4 GB or more.
- **This app needs about 2 GB of memory on its own.** The console refuses to enable it when the server does not have that much free; plan on a 4 GB server or larger.
- If the card shows an image not published badge, the app's build isn't available yet — the Enable button stays off until it is.

3. Enable the app

1. Open the admin console and scroll to **Apps**.
2. On the **Vibe Auth** card, click **Enable**.
3. Watch the badge: `not-installed` → `enabling...` → `running`. This usually takes a minute or two (first enable pulls the app's images).

Behind the button, the appliance creates the app's database and a restricted database user, writes the app's configuration file from a template, starts its containers, and only reports **running** once the app's own health check answers that it is fully ready. If enabling fails, the card shows the error with a recovery hint — fix the cause and click Enable again; re-running is always safe.

4. Open it and sign in

Domain mode	<code>https://vibe.<your-domain>/vibe-auth/</code> (replace <code>vibe</code> with your tunnel subdomain if you changed it)
LAN mode	<code>http://<host>.local/vibe-auth/</code>
Tailscale mode	<code>http://<tailnet-ip>/vibe-auth/</code>

The exact live URL for your install is always shown on this app's card in the admin console — use that if in doubt.

This app has **no default account and no default password**. Its first visit runs a setup wizard, protected by a one-time token, and that wizard creates the first administrator.

1. After the card shows **running**, look in the admin console for the **setup URL** and **one-time token** (the note below says which panel shows them). The token is shown once and is never stored anywhere else.
2. Open the setup URL (`.../vibe-auth/setup` on the app's address) and paste the token.
3. Create the first administrator (you choose the username). Store the password in the firm's password manager.
4. Finish the wizard. The setup URL stops working once it completes; the same section in the admin console then reports setup as done.

First visit runs a setup wizard gated by a one-time token. The console's Identity panel shows the link and token (also printed to the broker log: `docker logs vibe-auth`). The wizard creates the firm's first identity administrator; no default password exists (D13).

5. Setup on Windows

There is nothing to install on Windows for this app — it runs on the appliance server, and you use it from a browser (Microsoft Edge or Chrome, as your firm prefers). What follows is the Windows side of reaching it in each mode.

- **Domain mode:** just open the URL from the previous section. The certificate is real, so there is nothing to click through.
- **LAN mode:** recent Windows 10 and 11 resolve `<host>.local` addresses out of the box, but some office networks and VPN clients block that discovery traffic. If the `.local` address doesn't load, use the server's IP address instead: `http://<server-ip>/vibe-auth/`. The exact working URL is always shown on this app's card in the admin console.
- **Tailscale mode:** install the Tailscale app for Windows from `tailscale.com/download`, sign in to the firm's tailnet, and the tailnet URL from the section above works. The Tailscale icon in the system tray shows whether you're connected.
- **Bookmark it:** once the right URL loads, save it as a browser favorite (Ctrl+D) — or let your IT person pin it via a browser shortcut on each staff desktop.

6. Settings

Everything required (database, cache, secrets, URLs) is generated automatically when you enable the app. The settings below are the ones you may need to fill in yourself. Find them in the admin console under **Settings**, on the tab named in the left column.

Identity tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Sign-in page title	Firm name shown on the sign-in page and as the SSO button label in products. The setup wizard sets it too.

Email & SMS tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
SMTP host (recovery mail)	SMTP host for password-recovery emails. Inherited from the appliance Email settings.

Compliance tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Sentinel audit webhook URL	Sentinel audit-ingest endpoint (POST). Empty = audit events stay in Postgres + /data/audit.jsonl only.

7. Notes for this app

What changes when you enable it — and what does not. Vibe Auth is the appliance's identity broker: staff sign in once, with MFA, and every Vibe app you connect to it accepts that session. Enabling it changes nothing about how anyone signs in today. Each app keeps working on its own local accounts until you connect it and then choose its sign-in mode, one app at a time.

Order of work

1. **Enable Vibe Auth** from its card. First start takes longer than other apps (up to five minutes) because the bundled identity server applies its configuration before the health check turns green. Do not click Enable again while the badge says enabling...; the card tells you if it actually failed.
2. **Run the setup wizard** (previous section) from the admin console's **Single sign-on (Vibe Auth)** panel. Enrol MFA for the first administrator when the wizard asks. The Vibe Auth admin console is then at `.../auth/if/admin/` on the appliance address.
3. **Create the firm's staff** in the Vibe Auth admin console, or connect the firm's Microsoft Entra ID / Google Workspace so staff sign in with the accounts they already have. Put each person in the group that matches their role (for example `vibe-partner`, `vibe-staff`); apps map those groups to their own roles.

4. **Connect each app.** In the **Single sign-on** panel every SSO-capable app has a card. Click **Register**. The appliance registers the app with the broker, restarts it, and creates a local emergency account in it named `vibe-breakglass`. Nothing else changes yet — the app still uses local sign-in.

5. **Switch the sign-in mode** on that card, in this order:

MODE	WHO CAN SIGN IN	WHEN TO USE IT
<code>local</code>	Local accounts only (today's behaviour).	Default after registering.
<code>both</code>	Local accounts and the SSO button.	Roll-out. Have every staff member sign in once through SSO before moving on.
<code>oidc_only</code>	SSO only, plus <code>vibe-breakglass</code> .	Steady state. Local passwords stop working for everyone else.

Before you choose `oidc_only` for any app, save its break-glass password. It is in `/opt/vibe/CREDENTIALS.txt` on the server (line `VIBE_BREAKGLASS_PASSWORD_<APP>`) and in the app's Register output. Put it in the firm's password manager. It is the only way into that app if Vibe Auth is down, and the console refuses `oidc_only` until a break-glass account exists.

Apps enabled later

An SSO-capable app you enable after Vibe Auth is running registers itself automatically during its own enable. It still starts in `local` mode; switch it when you are ready. If a card shows not registered even though Vibe Auth is healthy, click **Fix registration** — it is safe to repeat.

Things that happen rarely

- **The server's name, IP, domain or routing mode changed.** Click **Re-derive issuers** at the top of the Single sign-on panel. Until you do, SSO sign-ins fail with a redirect error while local sign-in keeps working.
- **Rotate secret** on an app card issues that app a new client secret and restarts it. Use it if the app's configuration file was ever shared or copied.
- **Disable SSO** on an app card returns just that app to local sign-in. **Disabling Vibe Auth itself** first returns every connected app to local sign-in, so nobody is locked out, then stops the broker. Re-enabling later reconnects them; their modes start back at `local`.
- **Someone left the firm.** Disable them in the Vibe Auth admin console and end their sessions there; connected apps drop their session at the next request. Also remove any local accounts they had in apps still running in `local` or `both` mode.
- **Password recovery mail** uses the appliance's Email settings (Settings → Email & SMS). Without SMTP, an administrator resets passwords in the Vibe Auth admin console instead.

Emergency access

The emergency port reaches the broker's status page only. Single sign-on itself needs the normal web front end (the `/auth/` route), so if the front end is down, sign in to each app with its `vibe-breakglass` account until the doctor has the front end back.

8. Updates and rollback

- When a newer build is available, the card shows an **update available** badge. Click **Update**.
- Before updating, the appliance takes a database backup automatically. If the updated app fails its health check, it is rolled back to the previous version — and the **Roll back** button lets you do the same by hand.
- Updates are never automatic; nothing changes until you click.

9. If something goes wrong

- **Run the doctor first.** Admin console → **Doctor** → Run (or `sudo vibe doctor` on the server). It names the failing check and the fix.
- **Read the card.** Errors on the app card include a recovery hint; the output panel under the buttons shows the last action's log.
- **Emergency access.** If the normal URL is down but the app itself is running, `http://<server-ip>:5180/` reaches it directly, bypassing the web front end. Plain HTTP — use it from the LAN or Tailscale only, for getting back on your feet, not for daily work.
- **Disable / Enable** from the card restarts the app cleanly. Disabling never deletes data.
- Still stuck? `docs/TROUBLESHOOTING.md` in the appliance repository is keyed by symptom.